India State-wise Dance Encyclopedia

Project Objective

This document provides a structured starter framework for an exam-oriented Indian dance encyclopedia useful for SSC, UPSC, State PSC, Banking, Railways, and cultural studies.

Scope

- Cover all 28 states and 8 union territories
- Include classical, folk, tribal, ritual, martial, harvest, temple, and festival dances
- Add exam-friendly one-liners and current-affairs updates
- Build a workbook and CSV export for revision

Phase-wise Plan

Phase 1 – Data Collection

- List all 28 states and 8 union territories
- Verify official spellings
- Assign geographical region

Phase 2 – Dance Forms

Collect dance forms across categories:

- Classical
- Folk
- Tribal
- Ritual
- Martial
- Harvest
- Temple
- Festival
- Community-specific
- Regional
- Newly recognized cultural dances

Phase 3 – Dancer Database

Collect famous performers, Padma Awardees, Sangeet Natak Akademi awardees, living legends, and recent internationally recognized artists.

Phase 4 – Recent Current Affairs (2025–2026)

Include national festivals, Guinness records, UNESCO updates, government cultural initiatives, Republic Day tableaux, and awards.

Phase 5 – Exam Notes

For each dance form capture:

- State
- Category
- Community
- Festival
- Costume
- Musical instruments
- Occasion
- One-line SSC note

Phase 6 – Excel Workbook

Planned sheets:

1. Master Database
2. State-wise Summary
3. Classical Dances
4. Folk Dances
5. Tribal Dances
6. Important Dancers
7. UNESCO Heritage
8. Recent Current Affairs
9. SSC One-Liners
10. MCQ Practice
11. Revision Tables

Phase 7 – Excel Features

Filters, search, freeze panes, color coding, hyperlinks, dropdown filters, and sorting by state or category.

Phase 8 – CSV Files

Separate CSV exports for:

- Master Database
- Dancers
- Current Affairs
- State Summary

Phase 9 – Quality Check

Verify spellings, duplicates, states/UTs, current affairs, and SSC relevance.

Starter State-wise Dance Summary

State/UT	Region	Representative Dance Forms	SSC Relevance
Andhra Pradesh	South	Kuchipudi, Vilasini Natyam, Burrakatha	Classical and temple-linked dance traditions
Arunachal Pradesh	Northeast	Bardo Chham, Aji Lamu	Tribal and mask-based dances
Assam	Northeast	Bihu, Sattriya, Bagurumba	Classical and harvest celebration dances
Bihar	East	Jat-Jatin, Bidesia, Kajri	Folk and regional performance traditions
Chhattisgarh	Central	Panthi, Raut Nacha	Tribal and ritual dance forms
Goa	West	Fugdi, Dhalo, Dekhni	Folk and community dances
Gujarat	West	Garba, Dandiya, Tippani	Festival dance and cultural identity
Haryana	North	Khoria, Jhumar	Rural and folk dance forms
Himachal Pradesh	North	Nati, Dangi	Mountain-region folk dances
Jharkhand	East	Chhau, Jhumar	Tribal and masked theatrical dances
Karnataka	South	Yakshagana, Dollu Kunitha, Veeragase	Classical and folk dance traditions
Kerala	South	Kathakali, Mohiniyattam, Theyyam	Temple and classical dance heritage
Madhya Pradesh	Central	Tertali, Gaur Maria dance	Tribal and folk traditions
Maharashtra	West	Lavani, Tamasha	Popular folk and stage performance
Manipur	Northeast	Manipuri, Ras Lila	Classical and devotional dance
Meghalaya	Northeast	Nongkrem, bamboo dance	Festival and community dances
Mizoram	Northeast	Cheraw, bamboo dance	Traditional bamboo dance
Nagaland	Northeast	War dance, tribal dances	Ceremonial and cultural performances
Odisha	East	Odissi, Chhau, Ghumura	Classical and martial dance forms
Punjab	North	Bhangra, Gidda	Harvest and festive dance forms
Rajasthan	West	Ghoomar, Kalbelia, Bhavai	Folk and desert-region dances
Sikkim	Northeast	Chaam, Yak dance	Buddhist and ritual traditions
Tamil Nadu	South	Bharatanatyam, Karagattam	Classical and temple-based forms
Telangana	South	Perini Shivatandavam, Burrakatha	Classical and folk traditions
Tripura	Northeast	Hojagiri, Garia	Traditional community dances
Uttar Pradesh	North	Kathak, Raslila, Ramlila	Classical and devotional arts
Uttarakhand	North	Garhwali folk dance, Langvir Nritya	Mountain folk forms

State/UT	Region	Representative Dance Forms	SSC Relevance
West Bengal	East	Rabindra Nritya, Chhau, Jatra	Classical, folk, and theatre-based arts
Andaman and Nicobar Islands	Islands	Nicobarese dances, island folk forms	Coastal community culture
Chandigarh	North	Contemporary urban cultural performances	Regional cultural events
Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu	West	Local folk performances	Coastal and tribal traditions
Delhi	North	Kathak, contemporary dance, classical events	Capital cultural hub
Jammu and Kashmir	North	Bhand Pather, Rouf, Dumhal	Kashmiri folk and ritual forms
Ladakh	North	Mask dances, Buddhist ritual dances	Monastic and cultural traditions
Lakshadweep	Islands	Local island dance forms	Coastal cultural traditions
Puducherry	South	Bharatanatyam, folk performances	French-influenced cultural space

Expected Output

- 36 administrative units covered
- 350–500 dance forms drafted over time
- 500–800 dancer profiles planned
- 100+ current-affairs entries planned
- 700–1000+ master rows targeted